First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: 8 AM to 2 PM Tues. & Thurs.;
10AM-12PM Mon. & Fri.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Stephen McLaughlin

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans
An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

June 18, 2023

10am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Erin Grainger, Music and Choral Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS:

"The kingdom of God is a metaphor of transformation into more creative, more conscious, more caring, loving and fulfilling life with the fellow beings." — Amit Ray

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE *Te Deum* M. A. Charpentier

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

SUNG CALL TO WORSHIP

You are welcome here, **You are welcome here.**
No matter who you are, **No matter who you are.**
No matter where you are, **No matter where you are**
on life's journey, **on life's journey.**

You are welcome here, **You are welcome here.**
No matter who you are, **No matter who you are.**
Come and join with us, **Come and join with us,**
We're united in the church of Christ. **We're united in the church of Christ.**

MORNING PRAYER[1] **(UNISON)**

Gracious and ever-present God, make each of us an instrument of your justice. Continue to weave us into a family, your Kin-dom, showing forth your power of healing, feeding, clothing and resurrection as evidenced through the life and ministry of your son, Jesus the Christ. Bless us and our differences and sustain our courage to stand together in the face of oppression and injustice in this present world. We call on you today to gather us in your love.

WELCOME TO ALL VISITORS: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs, or would like to receive our Morning Reflections and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]FROM UCC WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

MUSIC MINISTRY HIGHLIGHT:



The *Church Street Sounds of the Season* series grew out of plans developed simultaneously, but independently, by the music directors at each host church.

As co-artistic directors, Donna Costes (St. Luke's) & Erin Grainger (First Congregational) cooperate to present fall and spring series to our communities. Our goal is multifold: to bring a variety of high quality music performances across the genres of classical, chamber, choral, and folk music; to provide a performance venue in the northwest corner of Vermont to our excellent musicians in the region; to share our beautiful church spaces with the public; and to allow these performances to be financially accessible to the public.

Locations

Spring performances are held at **St. Luke's Episcopal Church** in St. Albans VT, the church on the south end of the park with the red door (8 Bishop St, St. Albans VT).
Stay Tuned for Spring Concert Information!

Fall performances are held at the **First Congregational Church** in St. Albans VT, the church on the north end of the park with the clock tower (27 Church St, St. Albans VT).

MORNING PRAYER CONTINUED:

Impart to us the knowledge and understanding to better know you and glorify your grace on each and every step of the journey of our lives. In the name of Jesus, who came in the name of love, Amen.

HYMN*

"O God Our Help in Ages Past" (1, 2, 4) NCH 25

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(UNISON)**

Righteous God, we find ourselves as your hands, legs, heart and spirit here in the earth. As your children, as were your disciples, we are called to manifest a Gospel of love, justice, reconciliation and healing in the present world. But our concern for a just and egalitarian world too often dissipates at the point of our discomfort. Forgive us for our humanity and our frailty as we dwell in your presence and seek transformation and new energy for the work of your ministry. Revive us again O Lord.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN

ANTHEM

Fill Your Hearts With Joy and Gladness Sarah Quartel

SCRIPTURE READING

GENESIS 18:1-15

MATTHEW 9:35- 10:23

MORNING REFLECTION: ***It's a Miracle!***

HYMN*

"*Love Divine, All Loves Excelling*" (1, 2, 4) NCH 43

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

CHORAL CALL TO PRAYER:

Hear Our Prayer, O Lord D. Welpton

PASTORS' PRAYER~

LORD'S PRAYER

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

CHORAL RESPONSE TO PRAYER

"Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on Thee." Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

DOXOLOGY

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

OFFERTORY PRAYER

THE DEPARTURE

HYMN*

"Be Now My Vision" NCH 451

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE *The Star Spangled Banner* J.S. Smith

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Orlando Delgado Thank You for being our Greeter this month, your genuine hospitality is truly appreciated!

Free Open Mic and Coffee House
Saturday, June 24th 7:00-9:00pm
Theme: 80's Tribute!
Extra credit to anyone with BIG hair and clad in 80's fashion!
Don't know any 80's music—no problem, play what you like!
Join us for poetry, singing, storytelling, refreshments and fellowship!
Everyone is welcome: beginners, experts and everyone in between. For information, call Greg at 802-324-0308

***** 9am Summer Worship Begins on June 25th *****
Breakfast Church in the Chapel at 9am on 6/25
Join us as we break bread together around the breakfast table. If you like, bring a dish to share. All are welcome- bring a friend!

Save-the-date: August 12
Cookout at Greg and Melissa Beeman's in Fairfax!
More details to come.

Bible Study
Our next Bible Study will meet on June 21
6:45pm - 8:00 pm
Stories of Luke with Kent Gramm
Final Week: The Resurrection. Lk 24:10, 13-43
We are meeting IN PERSON, in the Fellowship Hall

Music Notes:
The composer of our anthem is Canadian Sarah Quartel. She is an educator in Ontario, Canada and works as a guest clinician at music education and choral events internationally. Her compositions have been featured in numerous concerts, commercial recordings, and international radio broadcasts. Sarah's choral works are performed by children, youth, and adults throughout the world.